

NEHEMIAH VII.

their genealogy; and I found a register of the genealogy of those who were come up at the first, and I found written therein:

6 ¶ These are the children of the province, that came up out of the captivity of the exiles, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried into exile, and who returned to Jerusalem and to Judah, every one unto his own city;

7 Who came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua', Nehemiah, 'Azaryah, Ra'amyah, Nachamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Misspereth, Bigvai, Nechum, Ba'anah. The number of the men of the people of Israel was:

8 The children of Par'osh, two thousand one hundred and seventy and two.

9 The children of Shephatyah, three hundred seventy and two.

10 The children of Arach, six hundred fifty and two.

11 The children of Pachath-mo'ab, of the children of Jeshua' and Jo'ab, two thousand and eight hundred and eighteen.

12 The children of 'Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty and four.

13 The children of Zatthu, eight hundred forty and five.

14 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and sixty.

15 The children of Binnui, six hundred forty and eight.

16 The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and eight.

17 The children of 'Azgad, two thousand three hundred twenty and two.

18 The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty and seven.

19 The children of Bigvai, two thousand sixty and seven.

20 The children of 'Adin, six hundred fifty and five.

21 The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.

22 The children of Chashum, three hundred twenty and eight.

23 The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and four.

24 The children of Chariph, one hundred and twelve.

25 The children of Gib'on, ninety and five.

26 The men of Beth-lechem and Netophah, one hundred eighty and eight.

27 The men of 'Anathoth, one hundred twenty and eight.

28 The men of Beth-'azmaveth, forty and two.

29 The men of Kiryath-ye'arim, Kephilah, and Be'eroth, seven hundred forty and three.

30 The men of Ramah and Gaba', six hundred twenty and one.

31 The men of Michmass, one hundred twenty and two.

32 The men of Beth-el and 'Ai, one hundred twenty and three.

33 The men of the other Nebo, fifty and two.

34 The children of the other 'Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty and four.

35 The children of Charim, three hundred and twenty.

36 The people of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.

37 The people of Lod, Chadid, and Ono, seven hundred and twenty and one.

38 The people of Sena'ih, three thousand nine hundred and thirty.

39 The priests: The children of Jeda'yah, of the house of Jeshua', nine hundred seventy and three.

40 The children of Immer, one thousand fifty and two.

41 The children of Pashchur, one thousand two hundred forty and seven.

42 The children of Charim, one thousand and seventeen.

43 The Levites: The children of Jeshua', of Kadmi'el, of the children of Hodevah, seventy and four.

44 The singers: The children of Assaph, one hundred forty and eight.

45 The gatekeepers: The children of Shalum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of 'Akkub, the children of Chatita, the children of Shobai, one hundred thirty and eight.

46 The temple-servants: The children of Zicha, the children of Chassupha, the children of Tabba'oth,

47 The children of Keross, the children of Si'a, the children of Padon,

48 The children of Lebana, the children of Chagaba, the children of Salmal,

49 The children of Chanan, the children of Giddel, the children of Gachar.

50 The children of Re'ayah, the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda,

51 The children of Gazzam, the children of 'Uzza, the children of Passeäch,

52 The children of Bessai, the children of Me'unim, the children of Nephishessim,

53 The children of Bakbuk, the children of Chakupha, the children of Charchur,

54 The children of Bazlith, the children of Mechida, the children of Charsha,

55 The children of Barkoss, the children of Sissera, the children of Thamach,

56 The children of Neziach, the children of Chatipha.

57 The children of Solomon's servants: The children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Perida,

58 The children of Ya'ala, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,

59 The children of Shephatyah, the children of Chattil, the children of Pochereth-hazzebayim, the children of Amon.

60 All the temple-servants, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.

61 ¶ And these were they who came up from Thel-melach, Thel-charsha, Kerub, Addon, and Immer; but they could not tell their family division and their descent, whether they were of Israel:

62 The children of Delayah, the children of Tobiyah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred forty and two.

63 And of the priests: The children of Chobayah, the children of Hakkoz, the children of Barzillai who had taken a wife from the daughters of Barzillai the Gil'adite, and was called after their name.

64 These sought for their family register, but it was not found: wherefore they were excluded, as unfit, from the priesthood.

65 And the Thirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there should stand up a priest with the Urim and Thummin.

66 The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and sixty:

67 Besides these were their man-servants and their maid-servants, of whom there were

seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven; and they had two hundred and forty and five singing men and singing women.

68 Their horses were seven hundred thirty and six; their mules, two hundred forty and five;

69 (Their) camels, four hundred thirty and five; (their) asses, six thousand seven hundred and twenty.

70 And a portion of the chiefs of the divisions gave unto the work. The Thirshatha gave to the treasure, of gold one thousand drachms, fifty bowls, five hundred and thirty coats for the priests.

71 ¶ And some of the chiefs of the divisions gave to the treasury of the work, of gold twenty thousand drachms, and of silver two thousand and two hundred manehs.

72 And what the rest of the people gave was, of gold twenty thousand drachms, and of silver two thousand manehs, and priests' coats sixty and seven.

73 So the priests, and the Levites, and the gatekeepers, and the singers, and some of the people, and the temple-servants, and all Israel, dwelt in their cities: and so came round the seventh month, while the children of Israel were in their cities.

CHAPTER VIII.

1 And all the people gathered themselves together as one man into the open place which is before the water-gate; and they said unto 'Ezra the expounder that he should bring forward the book of the law of Moses, which the LORD commanded to Israel.

2 Then did 'Ezra the priest bring forward the law before the congregation both of men and women, and every one that had understanding^a to listen (attentively), on the first day of the seventh month;

3 And he read therein in the open place which is before the water-gate from the first daylight until midday, before the men and the women, and those that could understand:^b and the ears of all the people were directed unto the book of the law.

4 And 'Ezra the expounder stood upon an elevated stand of wood, which they had made

^a Arnhem, "and explained all that it could be understood."

^b Arnhem, "teachers," i. e. that could explain; Philpsson, "and of those that explained."

for the purpose: and beside him stood Mat-thithyah, and Shema', and 'Anayah, and Uri-yah, and Chilkiah, and Ma'asseyah, on his right hand; and on his left, Pedayah, and Mishaël, and Malkiyah, and Chashum, and Chashbadanah, Zechariah, (and) Meshullam.

5 And 'Ezra opened the book before the eyes of all the people; for he was (standing) higher than all the people; and as he opened it, all the people became silent.*

6 And 'Ezra blessed the LORD, the great God: and all the people answered, Amen, Amen, with lifting up their hands; and they bowed their heads, and prostrated themselves before the LORD with their faces to the ground.

7 Also Jeshua', and Bani, and Sherebyah, Jamin, 'Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodyah, 'Ma'-asseyah, Kelita, 'Azaryah, Jozabad, Chanan, Pelayah, and the Levites, explained to the people the law: while the people remained where they stood.

8 So they read in the book, in the law of God distinctly, and exhibiting the sense: so that (the people) understood what was read.

9 ¶ Then said Nehemiah, that is the Thir-shatha,^b and 'Ezra the priest the expounder, and the Levites that explained to the people, unto all the people, This day is holy unto the LORD your God: mourn not, and weep not. For all the people were weeping, when they heard the words of the law.

10 Then said he unto them, Go your way, eat fat things, and drink sweet drinks, and send portions unto him for whom nothing is prepared; for this day is holy unto our Lord: and do not grieve yourselves; but let the joy of the LORD be your stronghold.

11 So the Levites quieted all the people, saying, Be still! for the day is holy; and do not grieve yourselves.

12 And all the people went their way to eat, and to drink, and to send out portions, and to prepare for themselves great joy; because they had understood the words which (the others) had made known unto them.

13 ¶ And on the second day there gathered themselves together the chiefs of the divisions

of all the people, the priests, and the Levites, unto 'Ezra the expounder, to obtain again intelligence of the words of the law.

14 And they found written in the law that the LORD had commanded through means of Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in booths during the feast in the seventh month.

15 And (they ordered) that they should publish and have proclamation made through-out all their cities, and through Jerusalem, saying, Go forth unto the mountain and fetch olive-leaves, and^c oleaster-leaves, and myrtle-leaves, and palm-leaves, and leaves of the three-leaved myrtle, to make booths, as it is written.

16 And the people went forth, and brought them; and they made themselves booths, every one upon his roof, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the open place by the water-gate, and in the open place by the gate of Ephraim.

17 And all the congregation that were re-turned out of the captivity made booths, and dwelt in the booths; for since the days of Jeshua' the son of Nun until that day the children of Israel had not done so. And there was very great joy.

18 And he read in the book of the law of God, day by day, from the first day until the last day. And they celebrated the feast seven days, and on the eighth day the solemn assembly, after the prescribed manner.

CHAPTER IX.

1 ¶ And on the twenty and fourth day of this month were the children of Israel as-sembled with fasting, and in sackclothes, and with earth upon them.

2 And the seed of Israel separated them-selves from all children of the strangers; and they stood forward and made confession for their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers.

3 And they stood up in their standing-place, and read in the book of the law of the LORD their God the fourth part of the day; and another fourth part they made confes-

* Rashi and Aben Ezra. Arnheim and others, literally, "stood up."

^b Governor; as in vii. 65, it refers to Zerubbabel.

^c Aben Ezra, "or," and so all through. Arnheim

renders עֵלִי with "foliage," which would then be the branches with the leaves; otherwise, עֵלִי means leaf, not branch. Philippson, "branches." עֵץ עֵלִי is the well-known three-leaved myrtle, not "thick trees."

sion, and prostrated themselves before the LORD their God.

4 ¶ Then stood up upon the stairs of the Levites, Jeshua', and Bani, Kadmiël, Shebanyah, Bunni, Sherebyah, Bani, and Kenani, and they cried with a loud voice unto the LORD their God.

5 Then said the Levites, Jeshua', and Kadmiël, Bani, Chashabneyah, Sherebyah, Hodiayah, Shebanyah, and Pethachyah, Arise! bless ye the LORD your God from eternity to eternity. And let men bless thy glorious name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise.

6 Thou indeed art the Eternal One alone: it is thou that hast made the heavens, the heavens of heavens, with all their host, the earth, and all that is upon her, the seas, and all that is in them, and thou givest life to them all; and the host of the heavens bow down before thee.

7 Thou art indeed the LORD the (true) God, who didst choose Abram, and bring him forth out of Ur of the Chaldeans, and change his name to Abraham;

8 And thou didst find his heart faithful before thee; and thou madest with him the covenant to give the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Emorites, and the Perizzites, and the Jebusites, and the Gergashites,—to give it to his seed; and thou hast performed thy words; for thou art righteous.

9 And thou didst see the affliction of our fathers in Egypt, and their cry didst thou hear by the Red Sea;

10 And thou didst display signs and wonders on Pharaoh, and on all his servants, and on all the people of his land; for thou knewest that they had dealt presumptuously against them; and thou didst (thus) make thyself a name, as it is this day.

11 And the sea didst thou divide before them, so that they passed through the midst of the sea on dry land; and their pursuers didst thou throw into the deeps, like a stone in mighty waters.

12 And by a pillar of cloud didst thou lead them in the day, and by a pillar of fire in the night, to give light unto them on the way whereon they should go.

13 Also on mount Sinai camest thou down, and spokest with them from heaven; and thou gavest them upright ordinances, and truthful laws, good statutes and commandments;

14 And thy holy sabbath madest thou known unto them, and commandments, statutes, and a law didst thou enjoin on them, by the hand of Moses thy servant.

15 And bread from heaven didst thou give them for their hunger, and water out of the rock broughtest thou forth for them for their thirst; and thou didst order them to go in to take possession of the land concerning which thou hadst lifted up thy hand to give it unto them.

16 And they and our fathers acted presumptuously, and hardened their neck, and hearkened not to thy commandments.

17 And they refused to obey, and remembered not thy marvellous deeds which thou hadst done with them; but they hardened their neck, and (spoke of) appointing a chief to return to their bondage, in their rebellion; but thou art a God ready to pardon, gracious and merciful, long-suffering, and abundant in kindness, and forsookest them not.

18 Yea, although they had made for themselves a molten calf, and said, 'This is thy god that hath brought thee up out of Egypt,' and had practised great provocations:

19 Yet in thy abundant mercies didst thou not forsake them in the wilderness; the pillar of cloud departed not from them by day, to lead them on the way; nor the pillar of fire by night, to give them light on the way whereon they should go.

20 And thy good spirit thou gavest to make them intelligent, and thy manna thou witheldest not from their mouth, and water thou gavest them for their thirst.

21 And forty years didst thou provide for them in the wilderness; they lacked nothing; their clothes did not wear out, and their feet swelled not.

22 Thou gavest them also kingdoms and nations, which thou didst divide into various corners:^a and they took possession of the land of Sichon, even the land of the king of Cheshbon, and the land of 'Og the king of Bashan.

* Aben Ezra; meaning, the Canaanites were scattered so that they fled before Israel. Rashi, "and thou gavest them their possession in a corner;" explaining, that they

(the Israelites) should not mingle with the other nations. Hercheimer, "thou gavest them possessions on all sides."

NEHEMIAH IX. X.

23 And their children didst thou multiply like the stars of heaven, and then broughtest them into the land, concerning which thou hadst ordered their fathers to enter in to take possession of it.

24 And the children entered in and took possession of the land; and thou didst humble before them the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gavest them up into their hands, with their kings, and the nations of the land, that they might do with them according to their pleasure.

25 And they captured fortified cities, and a fat soil; and they took possession of houses full of all good things, hewn-out wells, vineyards, and olive-yards, and fruit trees in abundance; and they ate, and were satisfied, and became fat, and delighted themselves in thy great goodness.

26 Then became they disobedient, and rebelled against thee, and cast thy law behind their back, and they slew thy prophets who had warned them to bring them back unto thee, and they practised great provocations.

27 Thereupon thou gavest them up into the hand of their adversaries, who oppressed them; and in the time of their distress they used to cry unto thee, and thou ever hearest them from heaven; and according to thy abundant mercies thou wast wont to give them helpers, who helped them out of the hand of their adversaries.

28 But when (once more) they had rest, they did again evil before thee: wherefore thou didst leave them in the hand of their enemies, so that they had dominion over them; and when they returned, and cried unto thee, thou wast wont to hear them from heaven, and thou didst ever deliver them according to thy mercies many times.

29 And thou gavest them warning to bring them back unto thy law: yet they acted presumptuously, and hearkened not unto thy commandments, and sinned against thy ordinances, which a man is to do, that he may live through them; and they rendered their shoulder rebellious, and hardened their neck, and would not hear.

30 Yet thou gavest them indulgence many years, and didst warn them through thy spirit by means of thy prophets; but they gave

no ear: therefore didst thou give them up into the hand of the nations of the lands.

31 Yet in thy abundant mercies hast thou not made an entire end of them, and thou hast not forsaken them; for a gracious and merciful God art thou.

32 And now, our God, the great, the mighty, and the terrible God, who keepest the covenant and kindness, let not be esteemed as little before thee all the hardship that hath befallen us, on our kings, on our princes, and on our priests, and on our prophets, and on our fathers, and on all thy people, from the days of the kings of Assyria until this day.

33 Nevertheless thou art righteous in all that is come over us; for thou hast acted (according to) truth, but we have done wickedly.

34 Also our kings, our priests, and our fathers have not executed thy law, and have not listened unto thy commandments and thy testimonies, wherewith thou didst warn them.

35 But they in their kingdom, and in thy abundant goodness which thou hadst given unto them, and in the ample and fat land which thou hadst given up before them, did indeed not serve thee, and they turned not away from their wicked deeds.

36 Behold, we are this day servants: and as regardeth the land that thou gavest unto our fathers to eat its fruit and its good things, behold, we are servants in it;^a

37 And it yieldeth its products in abundance for the kings whom thou hast set over us because of our sins; also over our bodies have they dominion, and over our cattle (also) at their pleasure, and we are in great distress.

CHAPTER X.^b

1 And because of all this, we make a faithful covenant, and write it down; and on the sealed document are our princes, our Levites, and our priests.

2 And with those whose seal was affixed were, Nehemiah the Tirshatha the son of Chachalyah, and Zidkiyah.

3 (Then) Serayah, 'Azaryah, Jeremiah,

4 Pashchur, Amaryah, Malkiyah,

5 Chattush, Shebanyah, Malluch,

6 Charim, Meremoth, 'Obadiah,

^a By being subject to foreign control.

^b The English version commences chap. x. at verse 2.

NEHEMIAH X.

7 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,
8 Meshullam, Abiyah, Miyamin,
9 Ma'azyah, Bilgai, Shema'yah: these were
the priests.

10 And the Levites: Jeshua' the son of
Azanyah, Binnui, of the sons of Chenadad,
Kadmiël;

11 And their brethren, Shebanyah, Ho-
diyah, Kelita, Palayah, Chanan,

12 Micha, Rechob, Chashabiyah,

13 Zaccur, Sherebyah, Shebanyah,

14 Hodiyah, Bani, Beninu.

15 The chiefs of the people: Par'osh, Pa-
chath-mo'ab, 'Elam, Zattu, Bani,

16 Bunni, 'Azgad, Bebai,

17 Adoniyah, Bigvai, 'Adin,

18 Ater, Chizkiyah, 'Azzur,

19 Hodiyah, Chashum, Bezai,

20 Chariph, 'Anathoth, Nebai,

21 Magpi'ash, Meshullam, Chezir,

22 Meshezabel, Zadok, Jaddua',

23 Pelatyah, Chanan, 'Anayah,

24 Hoshea', Chananyah, Chasshub,

25 Hallochesh, Pilcha, Shobek,

26 Rechum, Chashabnah, Ma'sseyah,

27 And Achiyah, Chanan, 'Anan,

28 Malluch, Charim, Ba'anah.

29 And the rest of the people, the priests,
the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers,
the temple-servants, all those that had sepa-
rated themselves from the nations of the
lands unto the law of God, their wives, their
sons, and their daughters, every one having
knowledge, and having understanding,

30 Held firmly with their brethren, their
nobles, and entered into a curse, and into an
oath, to walk in the law of God, which was
given through means of Moses the servant of
God, and to observe and to do all the com-
mandments of the Eternal One, our Lord,
and his ordinances and his statutes;

31 And that we would not give our daugh-
ters unto the people of the land, nor take
their daughters for our sons;

32 And that if the people of the land
should bring wares or any provisions on the
sabbath day to sell, we would not buy of
them on the sabbath, or on (another) holy
day; and that we would leave (the fields
without reaping in) the seventh year, and
(give up) every loan of hand.

33 And we established for us as one of
the commandments to impose on ourselves

(to give) the third part of a shekel in every
year for the service of the house of our God;

34 For the shew-bread, and for the con-
tinual meat-offering, and for the continual
burnt-offering, (for those of) the sabbaths, of
the new-moons, for the appointed feasts, and
for the holy things, and for the sin-offerings
to make an atonement for Israel, and (for)
all the work of the house of our God.

35 And we, the priests, the Levites, and
the people, cast lots concerning the procuring
of the wood, to bring it into the house of our
God, unto the house of our fathers,* at fixed
times, year by year, to burn upon the altar
of the LORD our God, as it is written in the
law;

36 And^b to bring the first-fruits of our
ground, and the first-fruits of all fruit of all
trees, year by year, unto the house of the
LORD;

37 And also the first-born of our sons, and
of our (unclean) cattle, as it is written in the
law, and to bring the first-born of our herds
and of our flocks to the house of our God,
unto the priests that minister in the house of
our God;

38 And that we would bring the first por-
tion of our dough, and our heave-offerings,
and this of the fruit of all manner of trees,
of wine and of oil, to the priests, unto the
chambers of the house of our God, and the
tithes of our ground unto the Levites; and
that these same Levites should be the re-
ceivers of the tithes in all the cities of our
land-tillage;

39 And that the priest the son of Aaron
should be with the Levites, when the Levites
receive the tithes; and that the Levites should
bring up the tithe of the tithes unto the house
of our God, to the chambers, into the treasure-
house.

40 For into the chambers shall the chil-
dren of Israel and the children of Levi bring
the heave-offering of the corn, of the new
wine, and the oil, and there shall be the ves-
sels of the sanctuary, and the priests that
minister, and the gatekeepers, and the sing-
ers: and that we will not forsake the house of
our God.

* Rashi takes this to be another term for the temple,
which was already sanctified in the time of Israel's fore-
fathers.

^b This connects with verse 33.